

FOOTFRICA

Product Requirements Document

The Professional Football Network for Africa

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1. Executive Summary

Footfrica is a professional football networking and talent discovery platform designed to connect players, clubs, scouts, coaches, and fans within a structured digital ecosystem.

At its core, the platform enables football players, especially grassroots and semi-professional talents across Africa to build credible football identities, showcase their performance, and get discovered by real opportunities. Simultaneously, it provides a vibrant community space where football fans can engage in match discussions, tactical analysis, debates, and stay connected to the grassroots football scene.

Platform Inspiration

Inspiration	What We Borrow	How We Apply It
LinkedIn	Professional structure & credibility	Structured player profiles as digital football CVs
Twitter / X	Engagement & conversation dynamics	Real-time football discussions, match threads, hot takes
TikTok	Video-driven discovery	Short-form highlight reels that drive talent visibility

The Result

- Careers are built like LinkedIn
- Visibility is driven like Twitter
- Talent is discovered through video like TikTok
- Community thrives through fan engagement and football culture

2. Vision & Mission

Vision

Build the largest digital database of football talent in Africa and the primary discovery platform for scouts globally while fostering the most passionate and knowledgeable football community on the continent.

Mission

To democratize football opportunity by creating a structured, credible, and discoverable ecosystem where:

- Every talented player has a path to visibility
- Every scout has access to organized, verifiable talent data
- Every fan has a home for meaningful football conversation
- Every career can begin and grow digitally

3. Problem Statement

For Players

Across Nigeria and many parts of Africa, there is a massive pool of talented football players who lack access to structured pathways for exposure and discovery. These players typically rely on:

- Local tournaments with limited attendance
- Personal connections and 'who you know'
- Random social media posts on platforms not designed for scouting

For Scouts & Clubs

Existing platforms (Instagram, Twitter, YouTube) are not designed for scouting. They lack:

- Structured player profiles with career data
- Contextual performance metadata (position, match type, key actions)
- Reliable credibility signals (endorsements, verifications)
- Efficient search and filtering tools

For Fans

Football fans — the lifeblood of the sport — have no dedicated platform that combines:

- Professional football networking with community engagement
- Grassroots content discovery with tactical discussion
- Connection to real emerging talent with passionate debate

The Result

Talented players remain unseen. Scouts struggle to find grassroots talent efficiently. Clubs miss potential recruits. Fans are scattered across generic social platforms with no football-first experience.

There is currently no unified platform that organizes football talent into a searchable, credible, and discoverable ecosystem while simultaneously engaging the broader football community.

4. Solution Overview

Footfrica solves these problems by creating a football-native professional network and community:

User	What They Get
Players	Structured profiles that function as digital football CVs
Clubs & Academies	Squad management tools and public talent showcasing
Scouts & Agents	Search, filter, and evaluate players efficiently
Coaches	Endorse, validate, and mentor players
Fans	A dedicated space for football talks, match analysis, debates, and grassroots discovery

The Player Journey

Stage	Description
Profile	Player builds structured football CV with career data
Performance	Uploads highlight videos with rich metadata
Visibility	Fan engagement and algorithmic boost surface content
Discovery	Scouts find and shortlist player
Opportunity	Contact initiated; trial or signing arranged

5. Target Market

Primary Markets

- Nigeria — initial launch market
- Ghana, Kenya, South Africa, Cameroon — Phase 2 expansion
- Pan-African rollout — Phase 3

User Demographics

Segment	Age Range	Description
Players	14–35	Grassroots, amateur, semi-professional, and professional footballers
Clubs & Academies	—	Local football academies, amateur clubs, semi-pro and professional clubs
Scouts & Agents	25–55	Independent scouts, agency scouts, club scouting departments
Coaches	25–60	Academy coaches, club coaches, national team coaches
Fans	14–45	Football enthusiasts, armchair analysts, supporters, bloggers, pundits

Market Size Indicators

- 500M+ football fans in Africa
- Millions of unregistered grassroots players across the continent
- Growing demand from European, Asian, and MLS clubs for African talent
- Rising smartphone and internet penetration across target markets

6. Platform Ecosystem — User Groups

The platform consists of five primary user groups, all interacting within the same ecosystem.

6.1 Players

The core supply side of the platform. Players create detailed football profiles that include personal and physical attributes, playing position and style, career history, performance statistics, and video highlights.

Category	Fields
Identity	Full name, display name, date of birth, nationality, profile photo, cover photo
Physical	Height, weight, dominant foot, body type
Football	Primary position, secondary positions, playing style tags, jersey number
Career	Current club/academy, previous clubs, career timeline
Stats	Appearances, goals, assists, clean sheets, cards (by season)
Media	Highlight reel (pinned video), video gallery
Social Proof	Endorsements count, follower count, verification badge

6.2 Clubs & Academies

Structured organizational profiles, similar to companies on LinkedIn. Clubs can create official profiles, list and manage squads, verify player affiliations, publish updates, and showcase their talent pipeline.

6.3 Scouts & Agents

The demand side of the platform. Scouts use advanced filters to search players, watch performance videos, evaluate profiles, save shortlists, and initiate contact. The platform transforms scouting from a manual, location-dependent process into a digital, scalable system.

6.4 Coaches

Validators and credibility anchors within the ecosystem. Coaches endorse players, provide public feedback, confirm player performance, create tactical content, and link to clubs. Their presence strengthens trust and credibility across the platform.

6.5 Fans

The community engine and engagement amplifiers. Fans are the heartbeat of the platform's social layer — they bring energy, engagement, and cultural relevance to the ecosystem.

Fan Capability	Details
Create fan profiles	Display name, bio, favorite club, football interests
Follow & build feed	Follow players, clubs, and other users
Post & engage	Share opinions, match reactions, tactical takes, transfer rumours
Match threads	Live discussions during matches
Communities	Topic-based groups (e.g. Nigerian Football, Tactical Analysis)
Polls	Match predictions, player comparisons, debate topics
Content amplification	Likes, comments, reposts that boost player visibility

7. Core Features

7.1 Professional Identity Layer

The foundation of the platform. Each player profile functions as:

- A CV — career information, clubs, stats
- A Portfolio — videos, highlights, media gallery
- A Reputation System — ratings, endorsements, verification status

This allows scouts and clubs to quickly assess position suitability, performance level, growth trajectory, and credibility status.

7.2 Social & Engagement Layer

Feature	Description
Text Posts	Share opinions, match reactions, updates, and hot takes
Video Posts	Upload highlights, training footage, tactical breakdowns
Image Posts	Share photos, infographics, match-day content
Comments	Threaded discussions under any post
Likes & Reactions	Quick engagement signals
Reposts	Amplify content to followers
Polls	Create interactive polls for debates and predictions
Match Threads	Live discussion threads around specific matches
Hashtags	Categorize and discover content by topic
Mentions	Tag other users in posts and comments

7.3 Video System

Video is the primary content type and the core mechanism for talent discovery.

Feature	Description
Upload	Support for MP4, MOV up to 5 minutes (MVP), up to 10 minutes (later)
Metadata tagging	Match type, position played, key actions (goal, assist, tackle, save)
Trim & clip	Basic in-app video editing
Thumbnail selection	Choose or upload custom thumbnails

Feature	Description
Playback speed	0.5x, 1x, 1.5x, 2x for detailed review
Full-screen mode	Immersive viewing experience
Video gallery	Organized collection on player profiles
Pinned highlight reel	Featured video at top of profile

8. Feature Breakdown by Priority

P0 — Must Have (MVP)

#	Feature	Description
1	User Registration & Onboarding	Sign up with email/phone, select user type, guided profile setup
2	Player Profiles	Full structured profile with personal info, position, stats, career history
3	Club Profiles	Organization profiles with squad management
4	Scout/Agent Profiles	Professional profiles with credentials
5	Coach Profiles	Professional profiles with endorsement capabilities
6	Fan Profiles	Lightweight profiles with preferences and activity tracking
7	Video Upload & Playback	Upload highlights with metadata tagging
8	Social Feed	Personalized feed with posts, videos, likes, comments, reposts
9	Follow System	Follow any user type, build personalized feed
10	Basic Search	Search players by name, position, location
11	Direct Messaging	1-to-1 messaging between users
12	Notifications	Push and in-app notifications for key actions
13	Mobile-First Design	Responsive web app optimized for mobile

P1 — Should Have (Phase 2)

#	Feature	Description
14	Advanced Player Search	Multi-filter search (age, position, height, location, club, foot)
15	Player Shortlists	Scouts can save players to private shortlists
16	Club–Player Verification	Players request club affiliation; clubs approve/reject
17	Endorsement System	Coaches and scouts can endorse specific player skills
18	Match Threads	Live discussion threads around specific matches
19	Fan Communities/Groups	Topic-based groups for focused football discussion
20	Polls	Interactive polls for debates, predictions, comparisons
21	Trending Topics	Algorithm-driven trending section
22	Verified Badges	Verification for scouts, coaches, clubs, notable fans
23	Content Moderation	Report inappropriate content, automated + manual moderation

#	Feature	Description
24	Profile Analytics	Players see who viewed their profile, engagement metrics

P2 — Nice to Have (Phase 3+)

#	Feature	Description
25	AI Player Evaluation	AI-assisted performance scoring from video analysis
26	Trial & Recruitment Events	Clubs post trials, players apply through the platform
27	Performance Analytics	Advanced stats tracking and visualization
28	Long-Form Content	Article/blog format for in-depth match analysis
29	Live Streaming	Stream training sessions or matches directly on platform
30	Agent Marketplace	Agents offer representation services; players request agents
31	Multi-Language Support	French, Portuguese, Arabic, Swahili
32	Desktop App	Full-featured desktop experience
33	API for Clubs	External integration for club management systems
34	Sponsorship & Brand Deals	Connect popular players/creators with brands

9. User Journeys

9.1 Player Journey

Step	Action
1	Sign up and create structured profile
2	Add career history and statistics
3	Upload highlight videos with metadata tags
4	Content receives engagement from fans and scouts
5	Algorithm boosts visibility
6	Scout discovers player through search or feed
7	Scout messages player and arranges opportunity

9.2 Scout Journey

Step	Action
1	Sign up as scout and set search preferences
2	Browse feed or use advanced search filters
3	Watch player videos and review profiles
4	Add players to private shortlist
5	Compare shortlisted players side by side
6	Message player or club to arrange trial/meeting

9.3 Fan Journey

Step	Action
1	Sign up as fan and select interests and favourite clubs
2	Follow players and clubs to build personalized feed
3	Post, comment, and react to content
4	Join match threads and communities
5	Discover grassroots talent through highlight videos
6	Build reputation as top contributor

9.4 Club Journey

Step	Action
1	Create official club profile with branding
2	Add squad members and link player profiles
3	Verify player affiliations
4	Post club updates, match results, and trial announcements
5	Respond to scout inquiries and manage applications

10. Feed & Discovery System

Feed Personalization by User Type

User Type	Feed Priority
Player	Content from followed users, clubs, trending discussions, coaching tips
Scout	Player highlights matching preferences, trending talent, shortlisted player updates
Club	Player content, scout activity, league news, community discussions
Coach	Player content, coaching community, tactical discussions
Fan	Match discussions, trending topics, player highlights, polls, community posts

Algorithm Signals

Signal	Weight	Description
Engagement velocity	High	How fast content receives likes/comments/reposts
Content type relevance	High	Match content weighted higher for scouts; discussion for fans
Verified user interaction	High	Content engaged by verified scouts/coaches gets boosted
Recency	Medium	Newer content preferred
User affinity	Medium	Content from frequently interacted-with users
Hashtag relevance	Medium	Trending and followed hashtags
Geographic proximity	Low–Medium	Content from user's region gets a slight boost

Feed Tabs

Tab	Content
For You	Personalized algorithmic feed
Following	Chronological feed from followed accounts
Trending	Top trending posts, hashtags, and discussions
Discover	Explore new players, clubs, and content outside your network
Match Day	Active match threads and live discussions (available on match days)

11. Search & Discovery Engine

A critical differentiator — the platform's advanced search transforms player discovery into a structured, efficient process.

Player Search Filters

Filter	Options
Position	GK, CB, LB, RB, CDM, CM, CAM, LW, RW, ST, CF
Age Range	14–40 (slider)
Location	Country, state/region, city
Height Range	cm slider
Weight Range	kg slider
Dominant Foot	Left, Right, Both
Club Affiliation	Specific club or 'Unattached'
Verification Status	Verified, Unverified, All
Content Activity	Has videos, Active in last 30 days
Endorsement Count	Minimum endorsements threshold

12. Trust & Verification

Trust is a foundational pillar of the platform. Without it, the ecosystem loses credibility.

Verification Tiers

Tier	Badge	Criteria
Verified Professional	Blue	Scouts, agents, coaches — verified credentials and identity
Verified Organization	Green	Clubs and academies — verified registration and existence
Verified Player	Silver	Players verified by a verified club or coach
Top Contributor	Gold	Fans with consistently high-quality engagement

Endorsement Skills

Coaches and scouts can endorse players on specific skills:

- Pace & Acceleration
- Ball Control & First Touch
- Passing & Vision
- Shooting & Finishing
- Defending & Tackling
- Positioning & Game Intelligence
- Leadership & Communication
- Work Rate & Stamina

13. Fan Community Layer

The fan community is not an afterthought — it is a strategic engagement engine that powers the platform's growth loop and amplifies player visibility.

Why Fans Matter

Role	Impact
Engagement Volume	Fans generate the majority of daily activity (posts, comments, reactions)
Content Amplification	Fan reposts and comments boost player content visibility
Cultural Relevance	Fan discussions make the platform a daily destination, not just a tool
Network Effects	Each fan brings their own network, driving organic growth
Grassroots Scouting	Knowledgeable fans surface hidden talent through community endorsement

Fan Reputation System

Action	Points
Post receives 10+ likes	+5
Comment receives 5+ likes	+3
Match analysis post	+10
Community contribution	+2
Flagged for low-quality content	-10
Content removed by moderation	-20

Reputation Levels

Level	Points	Badge
Rookie Fan	0–99	—
Rising Pundit	100–499	—
Established Voice	500–1,999	—
Top Contributor	2,000+	Gold badge eligible

14. Monetization Strategy

Phase 1 — Free Growth (MVP)

All core features are free to maximize adoption and network growth.

Phase 2 — Premium Features

Product	Target Users	Key Features	Pricing Model
Scout Pro	Scouts & Agents	Unlimited search, advanced filters, shortlist export, analytics	Monthly subscription
Club Pro	Clubs & Academies	Enhanced profile, trial management, squad analytics	Monthly subscription
Player Boost	Players	Profile boost in search results, priority video placement	Pay-per-boost or subscription
Fan Premium	Fans	Ad-free, exclusive communities, early access, custom badges	Monthly subscription

Phase 3 — Platform Revenue

Revenue Stream	Description
Sponsored Content	Clubs, brands, and academies promote content in the feed
Trial & Event Listings	Paid trial postings and recruitment event promotions
Brand Partnerships	Connect popular players/creators with sportswear brands
Data & Insights	Anonymized talent market data for clubs and agencies
Transaction Fees	Percentage on agent marketplace deals (future)

15. Technical Architecture Overview

Platform

- Mobile-first web application (responsive design)
- Native mobile apps — iOS & Android (Phase 2)
- Progressive Web App (PWA) capabilities for offline access

Recommended Tech Stack

Layer	Technology
Frontend	React Native (mobile), Next.js (web)
Backend	Node.js / Express or Django REST Framework
Database	PostgreSQL (relational data), Redis (caching, sessions)
Video Storage	AWS S3 / Cloudflare R2
Video Processing	FFmpeg pipeline, AWS MediaConvert
CDN	Cloudflare
Search	Elasticsearch / Algolia
Real-Time	WebSocket (Socket.IO) for messaging and live threads
Authentication	JWT + OAuth2 (Google, Apple sign-in)
Push Notifications	Firebase Cloud Messaging
Analytics	Mixpanel / Amplitude
Hosting	AWS / GCP

Key Technical Considerations

- Video optimization — Adaptive bitrate streaming, compression for low-bandwidth regions
- Offline support — Cache profiles and feed for areas with intermittent connectivity
- Low data mode — Reduce image/video quality to minimize data usage
- Scalability — Microservices architecture for independent scaling of feed, search, messaging, and video services

16. MVP Scope (Phase 1)

Timeline: 4 weeks

In Scope

Area	Features
Auth	Email/phone registration, user type selection, onboarding flow
Profiles	Player, Club, Scout, Coach, Fan profile creation and editing
Social	Feed, text posts, video posts, likes, comments, reposts, follows
Video	Upload, playback, basic metadata tagging
Search	Basic player search (name, position, location)
Messaging	1-to-1 direct messaging
Notifications	In-app notifications for key actions
Fan Features	Posting, commenting, following, basic polls
Mobile Web	Responsive mobile-first web application

Out of Scope (MVP)

- Advanced search filters
- Club–player verification workflow
- Endorsement system
- Match threads and communities
- Premium subscriptions
- Native mobile apps
- AI-powered features
- Analytics dashboards

17. Success Metrics & KPIs

Growth Metrics — Target: 6 months post-launch

Metric	Target
Total registered users	50,000
Monthly active users (MAU)	20,000
Daily active users (DAU)	5,000
Player profiles created	15,000
Club profiles created	500
Scout/Agent profiles created	200
Fan profiles created	30,000

Engagement Metrics

Metric	Target
Posts per day	2,000+
Videos uploaded per week	1,500+
Average session duration	8+ minutes
D7 retention	40%+
D30 retention	25%+
Feed engagement rate	5%+

Platform Value Metrics

Metric	Target
Scout-to-player contacts initiated	500+ (6 months)
Players shortlisted by scouts	2,000+
Verified club–player affiliations	1,000+
Opportunities created (trials, signings)	50+

18. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Low initial content volume	High	High	Seed with curated profiles; partner with academies pre-launch; onboard influencers
Fake profiles and fraudulent claims	High	High	Verification system, club validation, community reporting, AI fraud detection
Low scout adoption	Medium	High	Direct outreach to scouting networks; demonstrate ROI; offer free Pro tier initially
Video storage costs	Medium	Medium	Video compression, upload limits, cost-efficient storage (R2), tiered quality
Low bandwidth / data costs	High	Medium	Low-data mode, progressive loading, offline caching, compressed video streams
Content moderation at scale	Medium	Medium	Automated moderation (AI), community reporting, tiered moderation team
Competition from social platforms	Medium	Medium	Differentiate on football-specific structure; no other platform offers scouting + social + verification

19. Roadmap

Phase	Timeline	Theme	Key Deliverables
Phase 1	Months 1–4	Foundation / MVP Launch	All five profile types, social feed, video upload, basic search, direct messaging, fan engagement, mobile-first web app
Phase 2	Months 5	Engagement & Trust	Advanced search, club–player verification, endorsement system, match threads, fan communities, polls, verified badges, profile analytics, scout shortlists
Phase 3	Months 6–8	Monetization	Scout Pro, Club Pro, Player Boost, Fan Premium, sponsored content, trial/event listings, native mobile apps (iOS & Android)
Phase 4	Months 8–10	Intelligence & Scale	AI player evaluation, performance dashboards, long-form content, agent marketplace, brand partnerships, multi-language support, live streaming

20. Product Philosophy

The platform is guided by five key principles:

Principle	Description
1. Professional First, Social Second	Profiles must represent careers, not casual accounts. The social layer amplifies the professional layer, not the other way around.
2. Content is Proof	Videos and posts must reflect real ability and performance. Content is not just entertainment — it is evidence.
3. Structure Enables Discovery	All data must be organized and searchable. Structure is what separates this platform from generic social media.
4. Trust is Essential	Verification and credibility are foundational. Every interaction must feel legitimate and meaningful.
5. Community Amplifies Opportunity	Fans are not spectators — they are active participants who drive engagement, surface talent, and create the cultural fabric that makes the platform a daily destination.

Appendix — Competitive Landscape

Platform	Strengths	Weaknesses vs Footfrica
Instagram	Large user base, video content	No structured profiles, no search filters, no scouting tools
Twitter / X	Real-time discussion, virality	No player profiles, no video portfolio, no structured data
YouTube	Long-form video hosting	No networking, no messaging, no scouting workflow
TransferMarkt	Player data and statistics	No social layer, professional clubs only, no grassroots
Wyscout	Professional scouting tool	Expensive, no grassroots access, no community engagement
AiSCOUT	AI player evaluation	No social platform, limited to assessment only

Footfrica's unique position: The only platform that combines structured professional profiles + social engagement + fan community + video-driven discovery in a single ecosystem purpose-built for football.

This is a living document. It will be updated as the product evolves through user feedback, market research, and technical discovery.